manned fighters and ground command centers. It can share targeting data, receive mission updates mid-flight, and autonomously identify and engage threats. The aircraft is powered by an AL-31F or AL-41F turbofan engine, similar to that of the Su-35 and Su-57, allowing it to reach subsonic speeds with long-range endurance exceeding 6000 kilometers (Sapmaz, 2023).

A key operational advantage of the Okhotnik is its ability to act as a loyal wingman to the Su-57, extending its radar coverage and serving as a decoy or strike platform. In simulated missions, it has successfully demonstrated autonomous formation flight, AI-guided target acquisition, and coordinated attacks under limited human supervision. The UCAV's internal weapons bay is capable of carrying guided bombs, air-to-surface missiles, and electronic warfare payloads, preserving its stealth profile while maintaining significant strike potential.

Strategically, the S-70 Okhotnik strengthens Russia's capacity for network-centric warfare and strategic deterrence, aligning with the country's long-term plan to integrate AI, autonomy, and stealth into its aerial combat fleet. It also serves as a developmental stepping stone toward sixth-generation autonomous combat aircraft, setting the stage for future manned–unmanned collaborative systems in the Russian Air Force.

Figure 6.4 presents the Sukhoi S-70 Okhotnik, Russia's first stealth unmanned combat aerial vehicle (UCAV), showcasing its flying-wing design, stealth contours, and AI integration systems. The labeled diagram highlights critical components such as the AI-based mission systems, internal weapons bay, data link integration, and low-observable airframe. Designed for coordination with the Su-57 fighter, the Okhotnik's shape minimizes radar and infrared signatures, enabling it to perform high-risk reconnaissance and precision-strike missions in heavily defended environments. This figure underscores the Okhotnik's strategic role in